

Rough



Placer gold | This is a gold nugget recovered from a stream gravel deposit known as a placer (Spanish for alluvial sand). The nugget shows a typical battered and rounded form.



Gold in quartz | This specimen mined directly from one of the veins in the Earth is an example of the form in which it naturally occurs – as scattered grains in quartz.



Grains of gold | Gold nuggets are relatively rare in stream gravels. Most stream gold is recovered in the form of small grains or flakes like these.



Gold nugget | The angular shape and rough texture of this nugget indicate that it has not moved far from the place where it weathered out (became exposed).

The woman in gold

The Mona Lisa of Austria

With its unusual mix of naturalistic face and skin and Egyptian-influenced, jewel-like decorative detail, this painting is not just painted to look like gold but also *with* gold in a powdered pigment form. When the Nazis seized this work in 1940, they changed the title to *The Woman in Gold* so they could display it without reference to its Jewish sitter. Its restitution was the subject of a film *Woman in Gold* in 2015.



Portrait of Adele Bloch-Bauer I
Gustav Klimt, 1907, 138 x 138cm
(54 x 54in), oil and gold on canvas

Settings



Roman gold | The dolphin was a common motif in ancient Roman art. These large-eyed, drop dolphin earrings date from around the 1st century CE.



Scythian treasure | This elaborate gold pectoral was probably made by Greek goldsmiths in the 4th century BCE for a Scythian king in present-day Kazakhstan.



Cartier pen | Three views of this 2008 limited-edition Cartier gold pen show its dragon motif, set with 522 diamonds, six emeralds, and ruby eyes. The pen is finished in black lacquer.

Lacquer finish